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2.42%. NOT THE NUMBER YOU EXPECTED.

Buyer's agent commissions rose after the settlement that was supposed to cut them.

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THE RULES CHANGED. THE COMMISSION DIDN'T SHRINK.

A year after the new NAR rules began, the average buyer's agent commission is higher than it was the quarter they started.

REFUSING TO PAY A BUYER'S AGENT DOESN'T SAVE YOUR SELLER MONEY.

Redfin's own data shows the average U.S. buyer's agent commission fell to 2.36% in the third quarter of 2024, the quarter the new NAR rules took effect, then climbed back to 2.42% by the third quarter of 2025. A seller who won't offer a buyer-agent concession isn't cutting a cost. They're shrinking their buyer pool to whoever can cover that fee on their own, and the math pushes the number back up, not down.

WHAT TO SAY AT THE LISTING APPOINTMENT:

- 1 Lead with the number, not your opinion.**
"Buyer agent commissions are higher today than the quarter the new rules took effect. That's national data."
- 2 Name the real tradeoff.**
Refusing the concession doesn't save the fee. It narrows the buyer pool to whoever can pay it separately.
- 3 Price the concession in from the start.**
Make it a line item the seller expects at listing, not a surprise renegotiation at the offer.

THE TAKEAWAY

CUTTING THE BUYER AGENT FEE DOESN'T SAVE YOUR SELLER MONEY.

It costs them offers. The data says so, not you.